



Please take a minute to complete
the course evaluation.

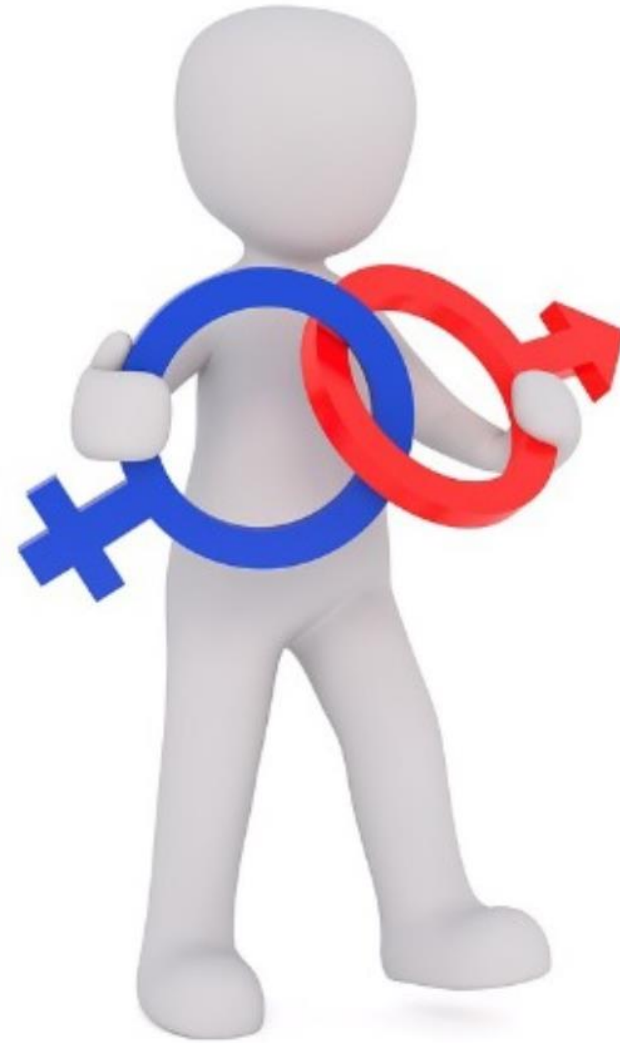
Thank you! 😊

Gender & Sexuality 1

LECTURE 23

SUMMER 2026

DR. MCPHEE



DAILY OBJECTIVES

- ▶ By the end of class today, students should be able to...
 - ▶ ...define the terms **sex** and **gender**, and highlight the differences between these terms.
 - ▶ ...describe gender differences in:
 - ▶ Aggression
 - ▶ Empathy
 - ▶ Sex Drive
 - ▶ ...describe the various possible origins of these gender differences.

SEX

► Sex

► Biologically determined.

► Genes

► Hormones

► Genitals

► Examples:

► Male, Female, **Intersex**

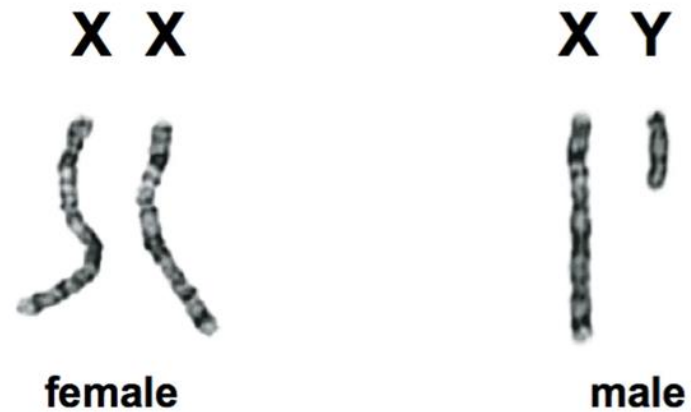
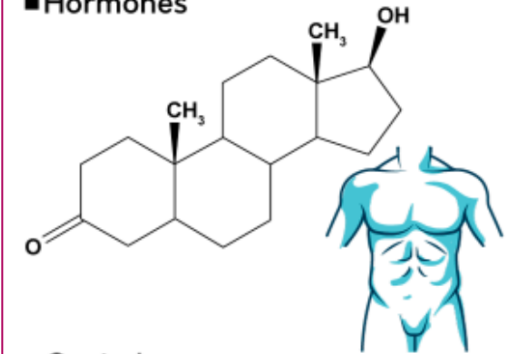


Image of XX (female) and XY (male) chromosomes.

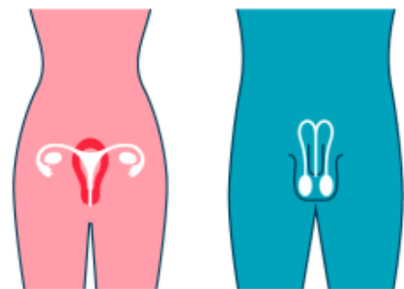
■ Genetics



■ Hormones



■ Genitals



GENDER

- ▶ **Gender**
 - ▶ Psychologically and societally determined.
 - ▶ Related to biology, but not determined by it.
 - ▶ Spectral, multifaceted.
- ▶ **Gender roles** are cultural expectations as to how women and men should look and act.
- ▶ **Gender identity** is whether a person subjectively feels like a woman or man.



TERMINOLOGY

Cisgender

- ▶ Gender identity that matches biological sex at birth.

Transgender

- ▶ Gender identity that differs from biological sex at birth.

Gender Non-Binary

- ▶ Don't identify as either male or female.

Transgender Woman

- ▶ Sex at Birth: Male
- ▶ Gender Identity: Woman

Transgender Man

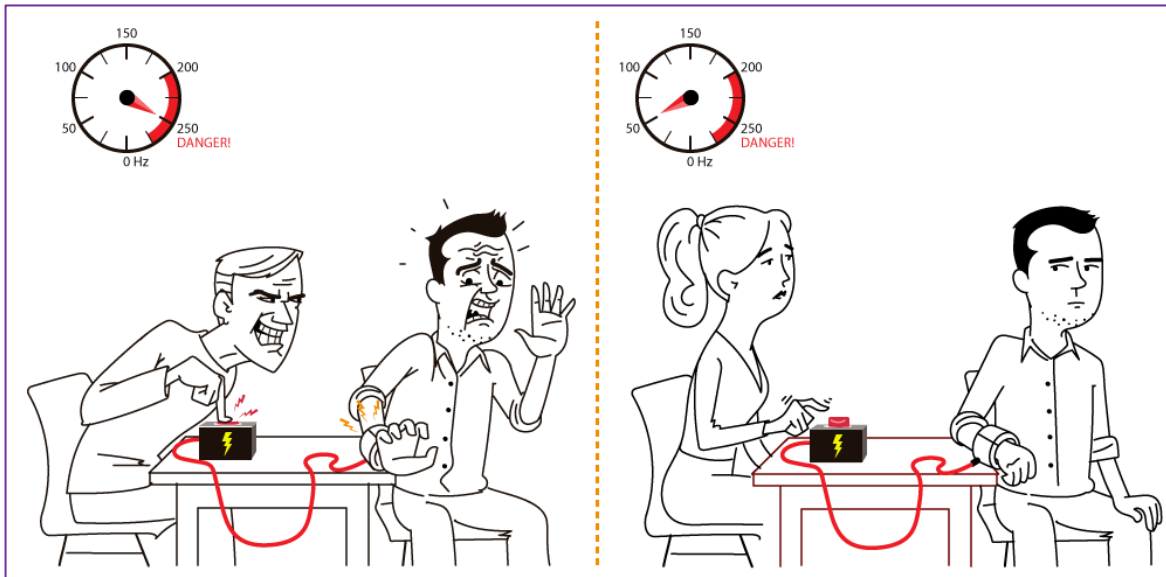
- ▶ Sex at Birth: Female
- ▶ Gender Identity: Man

Gender Dysphoria

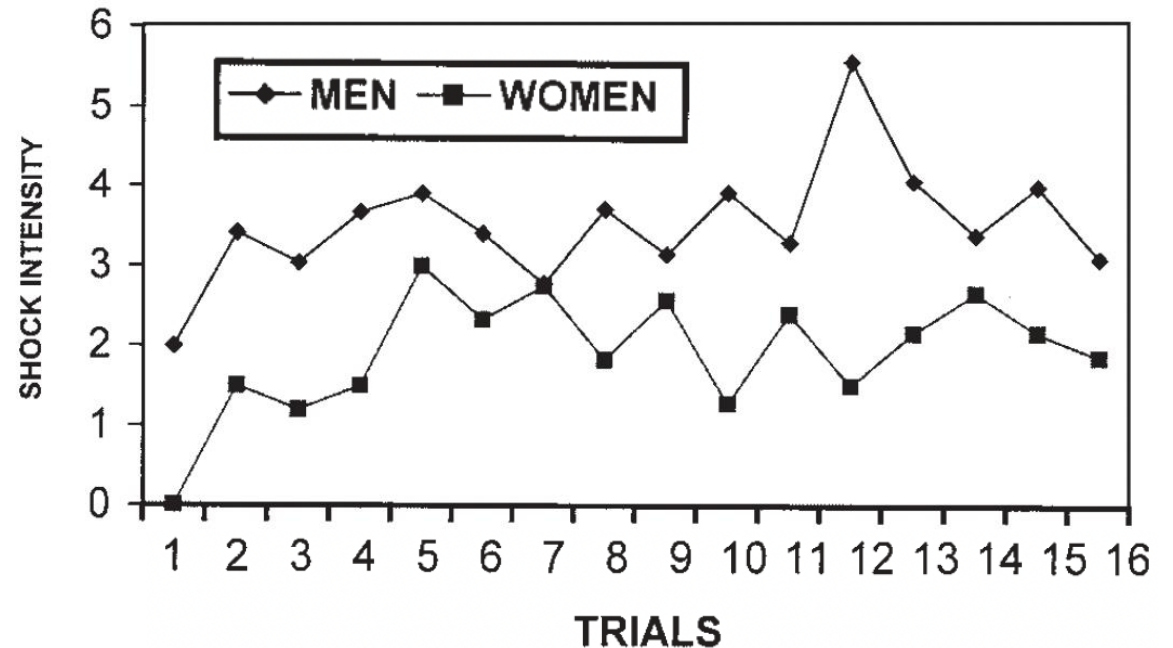
- ▶ Distress brought about by having a gender identity that doesn't match one's biological sex.
- ▶ Often helped by hormone replacement therapy and/or gender confirmation surgery.

GENDER DIFFERENCES IN AGGRESSION

- Men are typically higher in aggression than women.
- Men are 7 times more likely than women to commit violent crimes.



Men are more likely than women to shock others in experiments (Zeichner et al., 2003).



GENDER DIFFERENCES IN EMPATHY

- Women are typically higher in empathy than men.
- More likely to show “considerate” social behaviors (e.g., smiling, expressing interest, apologizing).
- More likely to develop emotionally-supportive relationships.



Women tend to share more intimate details about their lives with family and friends.

GENDER DIFFERENCES IN SEX DRIVE

Men typically have a higher sex drive and are more willing to have casual sex than women.

Gender	Attractive Stranger Offers Sex	Sexual Partners Each Month	Pornography
Men	75% agree to the offer.	25% want multiple partners.	6 times more likely to use pornography.
Women	0% agree to the offer.	3% want multiple partners.	Less likely to use pornography.

ORIGINS OF GENDER DIFFERENCES

- ▶ What can account for these gender differences in aggression, empathy, and sex drive?
 1. Evolutionary Explanation
 - ▶ Natural selection favored gender differences.
 2. Sociocultural Explanation
 - ▶ **Social Learning Theory** indicates that children learn gender roles by copying others and seeing what behavior is rewarded or punished.
 3. Sex double standard as a cultural explanation.

EVOLUTIONARY EXPLANATION FOR GENDER DIFFERENCES

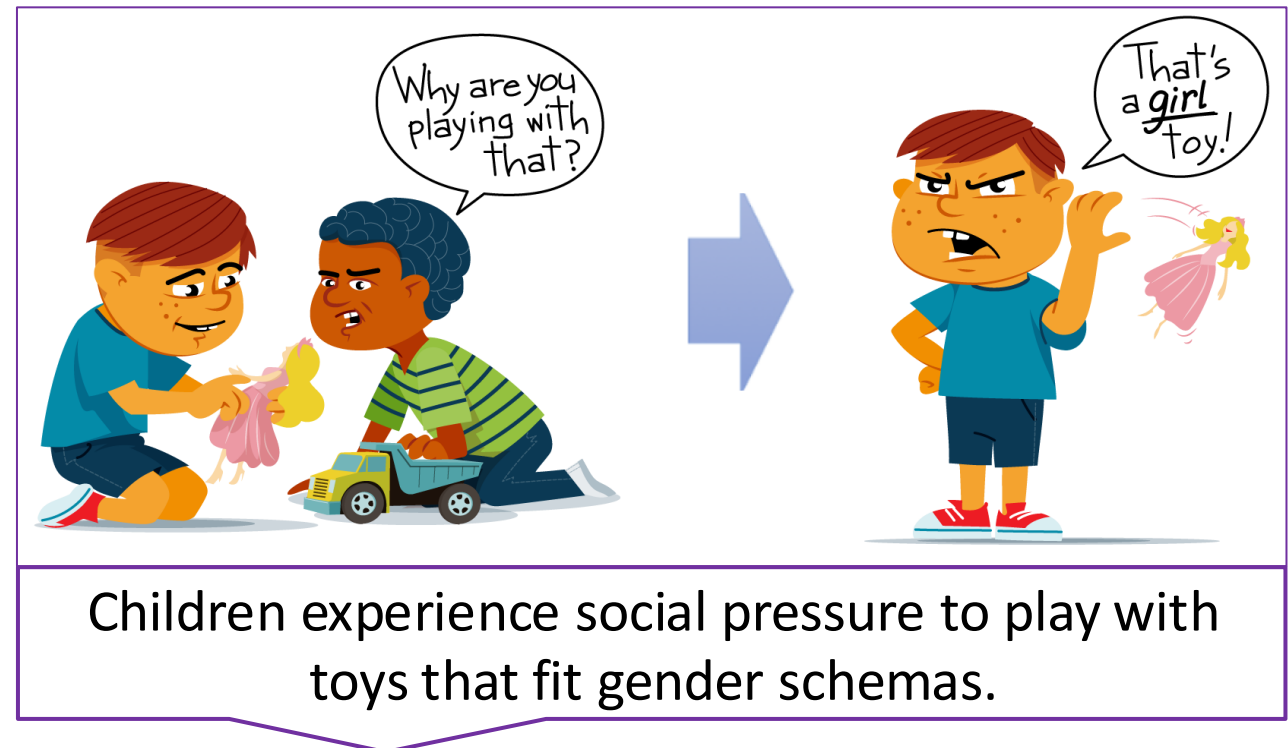
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- ▶ Men benefit from aggression.
 - ▶ Aggression helps men hunt, fight, and defend offspring.
- ▶ Women benefit from empathy.
 - ▶ Empathy helps women be better childcare providers.
- ▶ Women benefit from lower sex drive.
 - ▶ Lower sex drive helps women be “choosier” in mate selection.
 - ▶ Essential for women due to higher **parental investment**.

SOCIOCULTURAL EXPLANATION FOR GENDER DIFFERENCES

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- ▶ Social learning teaches children to conform to gender roles at an early age.
- ▶ Boys/men expected to be more aggressive and less nurturing.
- ▶ Girls/women expected to be less aggressive and more nurturing.



SEX DOUBLE STANDARD EXPLANATION FOR GENDER DIFFERENCES

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- ▶ Men who have multiple sex partners and engage in casual sex are praised.
 - ▶ Women who do the same are shamed.
- ▶ Differences in sex drive observed in cultures without gender equality.
 - ▶ Women less likely than men to engage in masturbation, use of pornography, and having casual sex.
 - ▶ Fear of negative social consequences.
- ▶ Similarities in sex drive observed in cultures with gender equality.
 - ▶ Women more likely to engage in masturbation, use of pornography, and having casual sex.